

to the home theatre system you wish to build, and how much you are prepared to spend for it. But here we shall restrict ourselves to what most readers may be looking for.

What's available?

As you will see in the accompanying boxes in this article, there is sufficient choice to select from. But you may have to do some leg work to select the equipment of your choice. Also, don't feel shy to ask for demo. Even though you may not be able to get an exact idea of the system's performance in the noisy showrooms, you will definitely get some feel of it. Besides, in some showrooms you may find demo rooms, or separate areas, to enjoy the music and take a call.

Don't be in a hurry to buy. Evaluate various systems based on their looks, size, sound and the price you would be paying for them. You may find a system the best, but the asking price could be too much. Go ahead if you can afford, but in most cases it may not be worth it—unless you happen to be an audio-ophile, or a very keen music lover. Ears of most of us are unable to distinguish the best from a good one!

Bose home theatre systems are the most expensive—as expected. The others are priced more or less in the same price range. So the first decision you may have to make is whether you are prepared to spend as much as the Bose systems cost. If not, you may check out the rest only.

Sony BDP-5370 Blu-ray Disc/DVD player has an MRP of Rs 9990 but is available for Rs 9000 along with two movies (of your choice). It permits 7.1-channel immersive surround sound and several other features. Prices and brief features of some complete Sony Blu-ray home theatre systems are indicated in a box.

Panasonic DMP-BD45 Blu-ray disc player is priced at Rs 10,990 (MRP) but is being offered at Rs 9500. Its salient features include PHL Chroma processor, ultra-fast 0.5-second booting (start) and an SD memory card slot. Panasonic also offers at least four DVD home theatre systems priced at Rs 7990, Rs 9990, Rs 15,990 and Rs 30,990, respectively,

Panasonic DMP-BD45

Features

- Fast booting Blu-ray disc player with SD memory card slot and USB terminal
- PHL Reference Chroma Processor Plus
- High precision 4:4:4
- 0.5 second ultra-fast booting
- SD image viewer



| Price: ₹ 10,990

Sony Blu-ray Home Theatre Systems



BDV-E870

BDV-E880

| Price: ₹ 39,990

| Price: ₹ 29,990

Features

- 5.1 channel Blu-ray disc home theatre system
- Immersive Surround Sound
- 1000W total power output
- BD-Live, BonusView, Bravia Internet Video



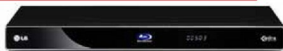
BDV-E980

| Price: ₹ 39,990

LG BD560

Features

- Full HD Blu-ray/DVD player
- USB direct recording and playback
- BD Live profile2.0 and Bonus view



| Price: ₹ 15,590